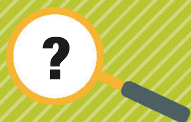
1 Research possible franchisors

Search for information online, but if possible, also attend franchise seminars and trade shows, where you can meet potential franchisors and ask questions. Compare types of franchise formats and fees.



2 Look for a proven formula

Assess the tried-and-true business models of brands that are already established in the marketplace. Look for examples of thriving franchise networks, and analyze the reasons for their success.

3 Match your skills

Consider how compatible you are with potential franchisors. What can you offer them, and what will you get in return in terms of business know-how and talent development?

4 Negotiate

Choose a location, and discuss the potential for being the only franchisee in the locality. Talk about what you will get and what is expected of you. Agree on product pricing and the percentage royalty on revenue you will pay.

5 Check financing and legal issues

Prepare a business plan and cash flow projection. Find the most cost-effective financing options, possibly through the franchisor itself. Seek legal advice, and read the fine print before signing anything.

6 Prepare the business

Pay any initial fees due to the franchisor, according to the contract. Find a site for your business, and set up the appropriate accounting and software operating systems agreed with the franchisor. Make sure you take full advantage of any other resources or services that the franchisor offers as part of the deal, including marketing, quality control regimes, staff recruitment and training facilities payroll systems, customer service support, and assistance and advice regarding relevant health and safety measures.

7 Get up and running

You will usually need to report to the franchisor and pay royalties on a monthly basis. Do this in a timely fashion to secure the ongoing support of the franchisor. Be prepared for quality control inspections.